Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

Keep in mind:
- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit
- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣5

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥K

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 1NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠7

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 2♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥8

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠10

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥4

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K Q 10 8 4 ♥ A 7 ♦ K Q 5 ♣ Q 10 6	
♠ J 7 5 ♥ K 9 8 3 ♦ 10 4 ♣ A K 4 2	N W E S	♠ 2 ♥ J 10 5 2 ♦ J 8 7 3 ♣ 9 8 5 3
	♠ A 9 6 3 ♥ Q 6 4 ♦ A 9 6 2 ♣ J 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♣5

NORTH has 17 points and might open 1NT. But with the 5-card Major suit she prefers to open 1♠.

SOUTH has excellent ♠ support but with 11 points is not quite strong enough to insist on reaching game. Instead he makes an invitational jump to 3♠, which NORTH is strong enough to raise to game.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ Q J 5 4 2 ♥ 8 3 ♦ 8 7 4 ♣ K J 9	
♠ 8 7 ♥ 10 6 4 ♦ K Q 10 9 6 ♣ 10 7 3	N W E S	♠ A K 6 ♥ A J 9 ♦ A J 2 ♣ A 8 5 2
	♠ 10 9 3 ♥ K Q 7 5 2 ♦ 5 3 ♣ Q 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East
Lead: ♥K

EAST has a powerful hand, but 21 points is not strong enough to start with a forcing 2♣ bid. Since he has balanced distribution he opens 2NT (20-21 points).

WEST adds her 6 points to EAST's minimum and concludes they should be in game. She expects her good ♦ suit to be useful to WEST in Notrump so she bids 3NT.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

♠ J 6 3
♥ A K Q 8 2
♦ K 6
♣ 10 9 5

♠ K Q 8 7
♥ 9
♦ A 9 5 4
♣ Q 8 6 4



♠ A 4 2
♥ 10 7 6 5 3
♦ 10 7 2
♣ A 3

♠ 10 9 5
♥ J 4
♦ Q J 8 3
♣ K J 7 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	1NT

All Pass

1NT by South
Lead: ♠7

NORTH has a solid 1♥ opening, 14 points and five trumps.

SOUTH must respond with 8 points, but cannot bid either minor suit since he needs at least 11 points to bid a new suit at the 2-level. So he bids 1NT (6-10 points).

NORTH doesn't object to Notrump so she passes.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ A 8 4 ♥ 8 6 ♦ K Q J 4 ♣ Q 9 5 2	
♠ K Q 10 7 3 ♥ A 4 2 ♦ 9 7 5 ♣ A 6		♠ J 9 6 2 ♥ K Q 7 5 ♦ 8 3 ♣ 10 7 4
	♠ 5 ♥ J 10 9 3 ♦ A 10 6 2 ♣ K J 8 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♠	Pass	2♠	
All Pass			

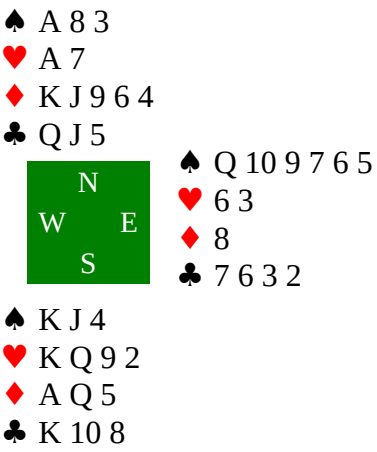
2♠ by West
Lead: ♥8

WEST has a normal 1♠ opening bid, 14 points and five trumps.

EAST has good 4-card support and 7 points, so she raises to 2♠, passed by WEST.

EAST does not consider showing the ♥s, first because she knows there is a ♠ fit, and second because she doesn't have the 11 points needed to bid a new suit at the 2-level.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by North
Lead: ♠10

With balanced distribution and 16 points NORTH should open 1NT rather than 1♦.

SOUTH's response is based on simple math. He adds his 18 points to the 15 minimum that NORTH has announced and comes up with 33 points combined. This is enough for a small slam, and since he has balanced distribution he bids 6NT.

Board 6
West Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ A 8 7 2 ♥ J 9 2 ♦ 10 9 7 ♣ J 3 2	
♠ Q J 10 9 6 ♥ A 7 ♦ A Q 6 ♣ A K 7		♠ K 4 ♥ Q 10 6 ♦ 8 5 3 2 ♣ Q 9 8 5
	♠ 5 3 ♥ K 8 5 4 3 ♦ K J 4 ♣ 10 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♠	Pass	1NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East
Lead: ♥4

WEST is right at the maximum for a 1♠ opening bid - one more point and he would have opened 2♣.

EAST does not have 3-card ♠ support but with 7 points must make some response. She cannot bid at the 2-level so she says 1NT (6-10 points).

WEST is fine with Notrump so he bids 3NT.